

Blind Ranking Sales Books

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 06, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/KRzc9rSFP44> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter blindly ranks five iconic sales and persuasion books, ultimately crowning *How to Win Friends and Influence People* the best sales book of all time for its universal principles on dealing with people.

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Final Rankings Overview [0:00](#)

- Brandon ranks five books blind (without seeing the cover first), in order from #5 to #1

Rank	Book	Author
#1	How to Win Friends and Influence People	Dale Carnegie
#2	Influence: The Psychology of Persuasion	Robert Cialdini
#3	Pitch Anything	Oren Klaff
#4	The Psychology of Selling	Brian Tracy
#5	Sell or Be Sold	Grant Cardone

#5 — Sell or Be Sold (Grant Cardone) [0:07](#)

- Reacts with clear affection: "That's my big homie, Grant Cardone. That's my dog."
- Places it at #5 not because it's a bad book, but because he anticipates stronger classics still to come
 - "It's a good book" — he has genuine respect for it, but hedges placement due to what he expects next

#4 — The Psychology of Selling (Brian Tracy) [0:00](#)

- Placed at #4 immediately upon reveal

- Endorses Brian Tracy directly: "Brian Tracy's the man"
- Considers it a solid, worthwhile read but not at the top tier

#3 — Pitch Anything (Oren Klaff) 0:22

- Ranks it #3 with strong enthusiasm
- Personal relationship with the book goes beyond casual reading:
 - "I used to read that book every month"
 - Had his **entire sales team** read it — used it as a team training resource
- Calls it "fantastic" — one of the most practically impactful books on the list for his career

#2 — Influence: The Psychology of Persuasion (Robert Cialdini) 0:28

- Acknowledges it is not strictly a sales book
 - Describes it as being "all about persuasion"
 - Notes that all its principles can be directly applied to sales
- Still ranks it #2 — calls it "a straight-up classic"

#1 — How to Win Friends and Influence People (Dale Carnegie) 0:35

- Also not marketed as a sales book — but Brandon argues that makes it no less valuable for salespeople
- His verdict: **"the best sales book of all time"**
- Scope extends well beyond sales:
 - Also calls it "the best dating book of all time"
 - Frames it as universally applicable: "No matter what you're doing in life, you have to deal with people"
 - "There's no better book on learning how to deal with people"
- Advocates for it being taught in high school: "I think they should teach a class on this in high school. The world would be a better place."

"It's the best sales book of all time. It's the best dating book of all time. No matter what you're doing in life, you have to deal with people, and there's no better book on learning how to deal with people."